

World's smallest SDR radio runs Linux!

Epiq Solutions has announced the world's smallest commercially available software-defined radio (SDR), operating on the 2.6.35 Linux kernel. The four-ounce Matchstick costs \$4,500, and incorporates a broadband (28 MHz) RF transceiver supporting 300 MHz to 3.8 GHz frequencies, an on-board GPS receiver, and an Ixela Atlas-I-LPe module integrating a Texas Instruments 1 GHz ARM Cortex-A8 processor and a Xilinx Spartan-6 FPGA. It's the first Epiq device to incorporate its own ARM processor and operating system. The company claims that the device has been designed for challenging signal processing requirements like portability, and can even connect with Android smartphones and PCs via Bluetooth, Wi-Fi or a wired connection.

Coming soon: Ubuntu for mobiles and tablets

If you are an Ubuntu fan, you will love this one. You will now be able to enjoy your favourite Linux-based operating system (OS) on your mobile handsets and tablets as well.

This free and open source operating system is all set to challenge Google's Android OS. Canonical's founder, Mark Shuttleworth, revealed that the company will focus on its longer-term goal of expanding to all computing platforms, including mobile phones, tablet devices and also smart TVs.



John McCarthy, AI and LISP pioneer, dies

John McCarthy, the man who coined the term artificial intelligence (AI), recently died at the age of 84. McCarthy will always hold a prime spot in the history of AI, because of his development of the LISP programming language used in AI. LISP is one of the most-used high-level programming languages today. Only Fortran is older, and that too by just one year.

McCarthy received the Kyoto Prize, the Japanese equivalent of the Nobel Prize, for lifetime contributions to computer science and artificial intelligence in 1988.

PayPal gets NFC support on Android

Now sending money or paying through PayPal has become much easier and more advanced. With NFC (Near Field Communication) integrated on Android phones for the PayPal app, users can easily send money, share bills or add money to their account through this advanced technology.

The NFC functionality on Android phones lets PayPal users check their account balance, withdraw money as well as view past transactions at any time. Furthermore, you have the option of requesting for money from someone who also uses an NFC-enabled Android phone.



Red Hat joins Open Compute Project

Red Hat has joined Facebook's Open Compute Project (OCP). The project, which was founded by Facebook, aims to build one of the most efficient computing infrastructures at the lowest possible cost. With this, Red Hat will collaborate with the Open Compute Project and its members on technologies, design and development to redefine the next-generation data centre.



redhat.

\$89 Open source motherboard launched

BeagleBoard.org, an open source hardware group, has launched a credit card-sized motherboard for \$89. It is based on an ARM processor and can be used for robotics, gaming and medical devices.



Named the BeagleBone development board, the motherboard is targeted at the open source hardware community, including hobbyists and engineers who write code for hardware with open source specifications. It has used the Linux-based Android and Ubuntu operating systems in its hardware.

The board is apt for embedded systems running specific applications, and could also be used in audio-visual systems and projectors. However, it is not applicable for smartphones, tablets or PCs. The USP of the open source board is that it is available at a pocket-friendly price. The BeagleBone measures 8.6 x 5.3 cm (3.4 x 2.1 inches). Other specifications include Gigabit Ethernet, 3D graphics, USB 2.0 and microSD controllers.